# F Lent 1 Grammar notes

## The perfect tense (ÊTRE verbs)

- The huge majority of verbs take **avoir** but a very common set of sixteen (and ALL reflexive verbs) , normally take **être**. These **"être verbs"** are:

> **descendre, rester, arriver, partir, entrer, retourner, sortir**
> **venir, aller, naître**
> **monter, mourir, tomber, rentrer, devenir, revenir (16)**

**Tip:** Laid out as above you get the "registration number" of:

> **DRAPER'S VAN MMTRDR16**

- All of the above **non-reflexive être verbs need to make the past participle agree** with the subject in the perfect tense. "An "e" is added to make a participle feminine, and an "s" to make it plural.
  - *Elle est alléE* *Elles sont rentréES.*

- Remember **ALL reflexive verbs use ÊTRE** as the auxiliary in addition to those 16 mentioned above.

  - *Nous nous sommes réveilléS* *Elles se sont vuES*

- **Try and remember this:**
  - 16 verbs use ÊTRE in the perfect tense
  - The past participle ALWAYS AGREES (see examples above)
  - All reflexive verbs also use ÊTRE in the perfect tense
  - The past participle **SOMETIMES** AGREES (see examples below)

  - *elles se sont vuES* *elles se sont parlé* (no agreement)

## When do past participles of reflexive verbs agree?

- More on this later, but for now, just learn that **they will agree unless** :
  - the past participle is followed by a direct object, such as part of the body
  - *elles se sont lavé LES MAINS*
  - the original verb takes an indirect object i.e «VERBER à qn »
  - *elles se sont écrit* *(écrire à qn)*

## Negative Expressions

- **In English we often use the verb "to do" to make other verbs negative**. "I like cheese but he doesn't like cheese". "I didn't go to the cinema."

- In French, it is impossible to use the verb "*faire*" in this way. Instead, **French uses two words which go around the conjugated verb** that you wish to make negative. The first word is always "ne" and the second word is usually one of the following:
  - **NE + pas[1]/plus[2]/jamais[3]/rien[4]/personne[5]/nulle part[6]/que[7]**
    *not[1]/no longer[2]/never[3]/nothing[4]/nobody[5]/nowhere[6]/only[7]*

  - *Je ne sais pas. Je ne chante plus. Je ne connais personne.*
    *Elle ne parle jamais. Elle ne va nulle part. Je n'aime que le thé.*

- In the perfect tense, **the two negative particles still go* around the conjugated verb**, i.e. the auxiliary verb.

  - *Je n'ai rien mangé. Elle n'est jamais allée en France.*

- * **Exceptions**: *personne*, *nulle part* and *que*. **These come after the past participle**.

  - *Je n'ai vu personne. Il n'est allé nulle part. Il n'a vu que Paul.*

- **You may start a sentence with the following negative particles,** but the *NE* must come straight after it:

  - **RIEN ne / PERSONNE ne /**

  - *Rien n'est cassé. Rien ne s'est passé.*
    *Personne n'est venu. Personne ne sait parler français.*

- You may use more than two negative particles in the same sentence. **The order is always**:

  - **plus/jamais/rien/personne**

  - *Il ne fait jamais rien. Elle n'oublie jamais personne.*
    *Elle ne dit plus jamais rien à personne*

- **After any negative particle**, ~~*DU/DE LA/DE L'/DES*~~ **become just** *DE*:
  - *J'ai <u>des</u> amis. Je n'ai pas d'amis. Il n'a pas acheté de pizzas.*
    *Elle boit <u>de la</u> limonade. Il ne boit jamais de limonade.*